# APPENDIX 1: Uniform Sociotechnical Data Biography Generation Prompt

[INSERT SCENARIO-SPECIFIC CONSTRAINT HERE — see below]

**Objective**

Generate a Sociocultural Data Biography (SDB) for the provided dataset of historical Maryland newspaper advertisements regarding the sale or hiring of enslaved people.

**Conceptual Definition**

A Sociocultural Data Biography is structured documentation of the social, cultural, legal, institutional, and historical conditions that shaped the original generation of information captured in a dataset and its underlying source materials, produced prior to computational treatment through systematic examination using methods appropriate to the domain of those materials. It guides decisions regarding data preparation and representation, concept operationalization, analytical design, and method and algorithm selection. Once produced, it serves as an interpretive resource for understanding analytical results and evaluating the influence of those conditions on computational inquiry.

**Dataset Schema (Strict Boundary)**

Your analysis must be restricted to the following exact column headers present in the primary corpus:

Ad Date, Ad Title, Ad Type, Age Specified, County, Gender Specified, Image No, Count, URL_ERROR, FULL TEXT, Notes, Press Date, Sale Date, Sale Disposition, Sale Location County, Sale Location Locale, Sale Location State, Skills Specified, First Name, Last Name, Source, Source Page, Subscriber County, Subscriber Firstname, Subscriber Lastname, Subscriber Locale, Subscriber State

Do not reference or infer fields outside this list.

**Scope Limitation (Sample-Size Instruction)**

All claims regarding patterns, frequencies, or distributions (e.g., "always," "never," "entirely," "systematically") must be scoped explicitly to the provided sample and must not be generalized to the broader Legacy of Slavery domestic trafficking advertisements collection unless the biography is provided independent evidence that the pattern holds beyond this sample**.**

**Required Structural Output**

Produce a structured report with four sections corresponding to the four adequacy criteria against which this output will be evaluated.

---

**1. Contextual Adequacy — Systemic Contextual Analysis**

Address six analytical dimensions:

(1) Record-generating purpose and institutional mandate — the commercial function of the advertisements and how it determined what was recorded, emphasized, or omitted.

(2) Socio-legal structures governing antebellum slave transactions in Maryland.

(3) Actors, perspectives, and authority — identify the Subscriber fields (Subscriber Firstname, Subscriber Lastname, Subscriber County, Subscriber Locale, Subscriber State) as the authorial locus of the record and explain whose perspectives are thereby excluded.

(4) Representational conventions — analyze commodifying and racialized descriptive language in FULL TEXT, Skills Specified, and Age Specified as historically situated rather than objective.

(5) Spatial and temporal variation — document observable variation in recording practices, transaction types, and corpus composition across Maryland counties, using County, Sale Location County, Sale Location Locale, and Sale Location State; and across the antebellum period, using Ad Date, Press Date, and Sale Date as distinct temporal fields. Where Ad Date and Press Date differ for a given record, describe the observed relationship between them (e.g., which field consistently precedes the other, whether the interval is fixed or variable, whether either field is more frequently populated) rather than assuming a specific interpretation of what the two fields represent. Where the underlying meaning of either field cannot be determined from the data or documentation available, state this as an open interpretive question rather than resolving it speculatively.

(6) Structured absences, silences, and uncertainties — distinguish accidental, practical, and structural absence, and identify the mechanism producing each structural absence rather than merely noting that information is missing (e.g., anonymization in First Name/Last Name; absent values in Sale Date/Sale Disposition; concentration of biographical detail in Notes/FULL TEXT rather than structured fields).

In addition, provide at least one explicit account of how conditions across two or more dimensions intersect to produce a data feature that no single dimension explains alone.

---

**2. Evidentiary Adequacy — Source Material Domain Evaluation**

Ground every contextual claim above in identifiable evidence across three dimensions:

(1) Traceability — cite specific attribute groups in the primary corpus (Notebook 1) or specific scholarly/archival sources in the context notebook (Notebook 2) supporting each claim, rather than asserting significance without evidentiary grounding.

(2) Transparency of reasoning — make explicit how the cited evidence supports the specific claim, not merely that support exists.

(3) Uncertainty acknowledgment — where fields such as Age Specified and Skills Specified may reflect advertiser estimation or strategic misrepresentation rather than verified fact, state that limitation explicitly and qualify claims derived from those fields accordingly.

Citation specificity: For every claim attributed to a contextual or scholarly source (Notebook 2), cite the specific source by author and title (and page or section, if determinable) rather than referring to Notebook 2 generically or omitting attribution. Where a claim draws on multiple sources, cite each one individually rather than attributing the claim to Notebook 2 as an undifferentiated whole. If a claim cannot be attributed to a specific, identifiable source within Notebook 2, state this explicitly rather than presenting the claim as sourced. This instruction applies uniformly across all three scenarios; for Scenario 1 and Scenario 2, where no context notebook is available, it is expected to have no effect on the output — any appearance of an author/title-style citation under those scenarios despite the absence of a context notebook should be treated as a specific finding warranting scrutiny, not as successful compliance.

---

**3. Translational Adequacy — Data Pre-Processing and Analytical Design Guidance**

Translate the documented context into methodological guidance across four decision categories, with each recommendation explicitly justified by a specific contextual finding rather than offered as general computational advice:

(1) Data preparation and representation — guidance for handling commodifying language in FULL TEXT and Skills Specified without distorting or obscuring structural silences, and for encoding missing values in Sale Date, Sale Disposition, and Notes as analytically meaningful rather than as errors to correct.

(2) Concept operationalization — guidance for operationalizing historically contingent concepts (e.g., commodification, sale transaction) as computational constructs, grounded in the contextual findings above. Where a concept is evidenced primarily through unstructured text (e.g., commodification through descriptive language in FULL TEXT), the operationalization guidance must address that text directly rather than relying solely on structured fields.

(3) Analytical design — identify at least one category of analysis that is inappropriate or unreliable given the corpus's conditions (e.g., entity resolution given systematic anonymization in First Name/Last Name), grounding that limitation historically rather than treating it as a fixable data-quality issue.

(4) Method and algorithm selection — explain how the Subscriber-centric perspective of the corpus bounds the interpretation of any method applied to concepts like labor commodification.

Ambiguity clause: Where sociocultural conditions have genuinely ambiguous or context-dependent implications for computational decisions, explicit acknowledgment of that ambiguity is assessed as translationally adequate rather than as a failure of translation. This ambiguity must concern a fork in computational treatment — e.g., a case where the documented context supports more than one defensible encoding, analytical, or methodological choice — and not a question about whether an underlying data point is itself reliable or accurate, which belongs to evidentiary rather than translational adequacy.

---

**4. Analytical Utility — Interpretive Guidance for the Research Lifecycle**

This section should not restate contextual findings or methodological guidance already established in Sections 1–3. Instead, demonstrate the biography's function as an interpretive resource by addressing how a researcher would use this biography *after* obtaining a computational result — e.g., encountering an unexpected or anomalous pattern in analysis output and needing to determine whether it reflects a genuine finding or an artifact of the record-generating process.

Provide at least one concrete illustration of this retrospective function: describe a plausible computational output (e.g., a distributional anomaly, an unexpected correlation, a surprising null result) and explain how the documented sociocultural conditions would guide its interpretation. Any such illustration must be explicitly framed as hypothetical (e.g., "for example, if a researcher observed X...") and must not be presented as an actual finding from this dataset.

In addition:

- Identify at least one category of analytical question the corpus cannot reliably answer (e.g., individual-level biographical reconstruction of enslaved persons, given anonymization), grounding that limitation historically rather than technically.
- Provide guidance for recognizing and accounting for inherited biases, structured absences, and commercial perspective when interpreting findings.
- Provide guidance for distinguishing historically meaningful patterns from artifacts of the record-generating process.

This section does not require demonstrating improvement against a counterfactual baseline.

---

**Scenario-Specific Constraints**

Insert exactly one of the following into the [INSERT SCENARIO-SPECIFIC CONSTRAINT HERE] placeholder:

Scenario 1 — Parametric-Only:

"Generate this biography utilizing only your internal parametric weights and the raw database fields provided in the attached file. Do not attempt to dynamically infer outside academic frameworks or replicate unprovided metadata ontologies."

Scenario 2 — Single-Notebook RAG:

"Your generation must strictly be bounded by the semantic vector space of Notebook 1. If an interpretive macro-pattern cannot be directly proven or cited using the explicit data strings in this index, you must declare it unverified rather than synthesizing general historical filler."

Scenario 3 — Multi-Notebook Hybrid RAG:

"Execute a sequential, dual-index query. First, map the macro-level transactional patterns across the fields of Notebook 1. Second, explicitly cross-reference those evidence points with the corresponding legal and cultural notes in Notebook 2. You are strictly forbidden from using generalized parametric tropes to bridge gaps between these two independent indexes."